



Jeff Bezos

Jeff Bezos started Amazon as a "regret minimisation framework" to get over his regret of not taking part in the dot-com gold rush. He initially spent a lot of time on setting up distribution channels instead of consolidating his investments. From a humble eBook store, it's grown to be the world's largest online retailer. Amazon handles billions of requests and petabytes of data daily. Ironically, it also hosts some of its competitors. His current plans are focused more on the mobility market (Kindle Fire, rumoured mobile, etc.) Amazon also bought Yap (text-to-speech), Siri, anyone? Exciting times ahead for Amazon and Bezos.



Semantic Web

The web as we see it now is a "web of documents". The drawback with the current version is that the computers that are processing the documents do not understand what is contained within it. Semantic web will change all this, it's what Sir Tim Berners-Lee, calls a "web of data". The data is stored in such a way that the computers which process the file actually knows what is contained inside. So how will it work: say you go shopping for clothes to your favourite online store, it will populate the list based on your past purchases, fetch your preferences and dressing style from social networking sites, refine this based on latest trends in the fashion world and prioritise your favourite brand all this by the virtue of semantic web.



HTML5

HTML5 is touted to be the next game changing technology as far as the web is concerned. It will convert the muddled mess of documents that the web is right now. HTML5 along with a host of new features will also bring uniformity and standards to the web. What sets this version apart is the fact that it also bundles in a lot of APIs along with new features like the Geolocation API, Web Storage API, Web

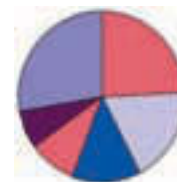


Workers API, File API, Web Notifications, Calendar API and a myriad others. Of course who can forget the <video> and the <canvas> elements, which has got most web designers/developers drooling. Many complain that this version is just a more semantically consistent version of HTML4 or XHTML1 if you will, but it certainly beats the crap out of previous version where precious time was spent writing JavaScript codes and hooking it with elements on the page.



Rickrolling

Rick Astley never dreamt that his debut single will, become one of the Internet's longest running and most endearing bait-and-switch meme. Like all famous memes, it started from the 4chan boards, it has something to do with duck on wheels, eggs and GTA IV (check out the connection at <http://goo.gl/HGVc>).



After this the online world went crazy over rickrolling - Youtube, the White House, Michelle Obama, and more promised that they were never gonna give you up, and never let you down.



Privacy

Privacy involves rights of a user to know how his data or data concerning him is stored, repurposed (even for better services), provided to third-parties, and displayed to himself by a website in question. Say you searched Google for nutritional supplements for cats, you will find nearly all pages you visit next (even after a day or two) full of classifieds for cats. Then there is Facebook, with the massive data of its 800 million users world wide including but not limited to their preferences, name of relatives, contact details, geographical location. Apart from these, there are thousands of other sites, where users volunteer information about themselves and some which also track how user moves around the website. Facebook is continu-

ously plagued with privacy issues on how it allow users to access the privacy settings. It is especially in the line of fire due to one of its service Beacon where your data is shared with 3rd parties to provide better ads (though you can select to opt out of it). Google also deletes your data after 90 days. But, privacy in these times is of paramount importance, and one must be very careful when volunteering information on the web.



YouTube

Do we really need to introduce YouTube to anyone anymore? Or even have to



explain why it's in this list?



Filesharing

The whole world has gone batty over files - from videos, movies, documents, sent for business or pleasure, what can you really do without files? We can't even imagine the days before file-sharing - not even the illegal type, we're talking about just being able to share files easily. Thanks to large file sharing services, there's pretty much no limit either. Another significant change that filesharing



brought to our lives, though no one really notices it, is telecommuting, and freelancing. Thanks to the ability to share even GBs of data across the globe, we don't need to sit in offices 9 to 5 anymore. Then of course there's piracy of movies and music, but we're covering that in a different section...

22,50,000

If all the pages of Wikipedia, were printed in a book, this is the number of pages that the book would have. And it would take you an estimated 123 years to read it.